ANALYSIS SUMMARY: Sample Sales Data (2003-2005)

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Business question

Where should the sales team focus effort next quarter to grow revenue, and where is revenue currently at risk?

Dataset

2,823-line items across 307 distinct orders, spanning January 2003 to May 2005. Four territories: EMEA, NA, APAC, Japan. Seven product lines. Cleaned in Power Query (removed 7 unused columns, standardized text, added diagnostic columns, grouped order statuses). All year-over-year comparisons use a Jan–May filter to keep years comparable, as the dataset ends May 31, 2005.

Growth findings

Finding 1: Revenue is growing strongly, across every product line.

Global revenue for Jan–May grew from $839K (2003) → $1.31M (2004) → $1.79M (2005). That's +113% over two years. Every one of the seven product lines grew, including the slowest (Trucks and Buses, +77%) and the fastest (Motorcycles, +180%).

Finding 2: The business is heavily concentrated in EMEA and NA.

EMEA + NA = 89.4% of Jan–May 2005 revenue ($1.60M of $1.79M). EMEA alone is 52% ($930K). APAC is 8%, Japan is 2.4%. This is both a strength (predictable core) and a risk (over-dependence on two regions).

Finding 3: Classic Cars is the dominant product and still growing.

Classic Cars = 37.5% of 2005 revenue ($673K of $1.79M). It grew +107% over two years. Combined with Vintage Cars, car products = 58% of revenue. Concentration is high, but currently growing, so it is not a present concern, but worth monitoring.

Finding 4: APAC has a fundamentally different product mix than EMEA and NA.

Product	APAC mix	EMEA mix
Vintage Cars	39%	9%
Trucks and Buses	20%	9%
Classic Cars	21%	41%

APAC customers want Vintage Cars and Trucks. EMEA customers want Classic Cars. The business is not currently serving these two markets differently.

Finding 5: Japan is the only shrinking territory.

Japan's Jan–May revenue: $99K (2003) → $68K (2004) → $43K (2005). The decline is driven almost entirely by Classic Cars ($63K → $19K). With only 14 orders across 3 years, this likely reflects the loss of one or two key customers rather than a market-wide decline.

Growth recommendations

Recommendation 1: Protect and grow the EMEA + NA core.

EMEA and NA are 89% of revenue and growing. Classic Cars is 37.5% of global revenue and grew +107%. Recommendation: continue investing in EMEA and NA Classic Cars. Do not starve the core while pursuing new opportunities.

Recommendation 2: Adjust the APAC product strategy to match local preferences.

APAC's customers buy different products than EMEA's: Vintage Cars and Trucks, not Classic Cars. Recommendation: adjust APAC inventory, sales targets, and marketing to lean into Vintage Cars and Trucks. This is a strategic shift, not a cost increase.

Flag: Japan requires a decision.

Japan is shrinking and too small (2.4%) to absorb growth investment. Recommendation: investigate whether the lost Japan Classic Cars accounts are recoverable. If yes, re-engage. If no, formally deprioritize Japan so sales effort isn't spent on a non-growing market.

Risk findings

Finding 1: The order book is 94.5% clean.

Of 307 distinct orders:

- 290 Clean (94.5%): shipped or resolved
- 7 At Risk (2.3%): on hold or disputed
- 4 Failed (1.3%): cancelled
- 6 Pending (2.0%): placed in the final 3 days of the dataset; excluded from risk rates

Risk rate on completed orders: 3.65%.

Finding 2: Revenue exposure from risky orders is modest but quantified.

At Risk + Failed orders represent $445,679 of revenue, or 4.4% of total. This is high relative to order count (3.65%), suggesting risky orders tend to be larger than average.

Risk limitations

Only 11 problematic orders total. Per-territory and per-product risk rates are unreliable due to small samples. A single order can swing a territory's rate by several percentage points.

Japan (14 orders) and APAC (23 orders) are too small for reliable risk comparison.

Pending orders (6) excluded from risk-rate denominator as they haven't had the opportunity to complete or fail.

Data limitations

Sales anomaly: Approximately 45% of rows had Sales ≠ Quantity × Price Each, averaging +39% higher than expected. Hypothesis testing ruled out MSRP-based pricing (explains 1.8%), product-line markup, fixed fee, and system-change explanations. Since Sales is always positive and represents the recorded transaction value, it was retained as the authoritative revenue measure. Price Each was excluded from revenue calculations. Documented as a known data limitation.

What I'd do with more time & Information from Stakeholders

Investigate the Sales anomaly further: the variance pattern is systematic but unexplained. A conversation with the data owner would clarify whether Sales includes tax, shipping, or markups.

Customer-level analysis: the dataset has Customer Name. Customer concentration could add depth to the growth recommendation.

Discount analysis: using Price vs MSRP and Effective Price vs MSRP, I could measure whether deeper discounts correlate with higher or lower deal sizes. That would test whether the current pricing approach supports or undermines the growth strategy.

Extend the risk analysis: if I had access to order-level timestamps (not just dates), I could measure fulfilment cycle time and identify where orders get stuck.

Thank you for taking time to read.